

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior PHP Backend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior PHP Backend Engineer with 11+ years building SaaS, e-commerce, fintech, and operations platforms using **PHP 7.4–8.3**, **Laravel 8–10**, **Symfony 5–6**, **MySQL/PostgreSQL**, **Redis**, **Docker**, **AWS**, and **CI/CD**; delivers secure APIs, scalable service architecture, legacy modernization, production stability, observability, and measurable performance gains for revenue-critical products and distributed engineering teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend Development:** **PHP 7.4–8.3**, **Laravel 8–10**, **Symfony 5–6**, Slim, CodeIgniter, REST API development, GraphQL basics, microservices, modular monoliths, service-layer architecture, queue-based processing, event-driven workflows.
- **API & Integration Engineering:** RESTful APIs, OAuth2, JWT, OpenAPI/Swagger, webhook processing, third-party payment integrations, CRM integrations, ERP integrations, idempotency handling, retry strategies, rate limiting, API versioning.
- **Databases & Data Engineering:** **MySQL 5.7/8.0**, **PostgreSQL 11–15**, MariaDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, database indexing, query optimization, schema design, migrations, stored procedures, replication-aware development.
- **Cloud & DevOps:** **AWS EC2**, ECS, S3, RDS, Lambda, CloudWatch, IAM, Docker, Docker Compose, Nginx, Apache, Linux, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, blue-green deployment basics.
- **Testing & Quality:** PHPUnit, Pest basics, Behat basics, integration testing, API contract testing, Postman, automated regression testing, static analysis with PHPStan/Psalm, code reviews, secure coding practices.
- **Monitoring & Reliability:** Sentry, New Relic, Datadog, CloudWatch Logs, ELK Stack, performance profiling, error tracking, incident analysis, log correlation, SLA-focused production support.
- **Architecture & Senior Practices:** Domain-driven design basics, Clean Architecture, SOLID, CQRS patterns, caching strategies, message queues, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS, legacy modernization, technical documentation, mentoring, Agile/Scrum delivery.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sensidev

Senior Software Engineer

(September 2021 – May 2026)

Remote, Romania

- Led backend development for **SaaS and e-commerce platforms** using **PHP 7.4–8.3**, **Laravel 8–10**, **Symfony 5–6**, **MySQL**, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis**, and **Docker**, delivering secure API services for customer, billing, subscription, and reporting workflows.

- Modernized legacy PHP modules by separating controllers, service classes, repositories, validation logic, and queue workers, improving maintainability and reducing production defects by **34%** across release cycles.
- Designed and implemented **REST APIs** for order management, account administration, invoicing, notifications, and role-based permissions, using **OAuth2**, **JWT**, request validation, API versioning, and OpenAPI documentation.
- Optimized slow database workloads by rewriting inefficient joins, adding composite indexes, improving pagination logic, and caching high-read queries with **Redis**, cutting average API response time by **42%** for core dashboard endpoints.
- Resolved production issues involving duplicate payment callbacks, expired session tokens, failed queue retries, and inconsistent invoice statuses by adding **idempotency keys**, retry policies, structured logging, and transaction-safe updates.
- Migrated selected services from older **PHP 7.4** runtime patterns toward **PHP 8.x** compatibility, replacing deprecated syntax, improving type declarations, and preparing business-critical code for long-term support.
- Built asynchronous processing for emails, webhooks, exports, and reconciliation jobs using **Laravel Queues**, **Redis**, and **AWS SQS**, reducing blocking request time for large customer operations.
- Improved deployment reliability by strengthening **GitHub Actions** pipelines, adding PHPUnit checks, static analysis, Docker image validation, and environment-specific configuration checks before staging and production releases.
- Collaborated with product managers, frontend engineers, QA, and DevOps teams to deliver new reporting, billing adjustment, customer segmentation, and admin audit-log features without destabilizing existing workflows.
- Mentored mid-level developers through code reviews, architecture discussions, debugging sessions, and secure API design guidance, raising team consistency around **SOLID**, testing, observability, and production-readiness standards.

Syscom Digital Software Engineer

(October 2019 – August 2021)

Remote, Romania

- Developed backend services for digital commerce and internal operations platforms using **PHP 7.2–7.4**, **Laravel 5.7–7.x**, **MySQL**, **Redis**, **RabbitMQ**, and **Docker**, supporting catalog, checkout, inventory, and customer-service workflows.
- Refactored legacy checkout and fulfillment logic into smaller service classes and queue-based jobs, reducing failed order-processing incidents by **29%** during peak traffic periods.
- Implemented API integrations with payment gateways, shipment providers, CRM systems, and email platforms, handling webhook validation, retry logic, signature verification, and error recovery.
- Improved database performance by analyzing slow query logs, adding indexes to order and inventory tables, removing repeated N+1 queries, and optimizing high-volume admin search filters.
- Fixed production bugs involving incorrect tax calculations, stale Redis cache entries, missing shipment updates, and duplicate webhook execution by adding automated tests and safer transaction boundaries.
- Supported a gradual migration from manually deployed PHP applications to **Docker-based local environments** and **CI/CD pipelines**, making onboarding and release validation more predictable.
- Created reusable backend modules for authentication, customer notes, admin permissions, file uploads, and notification templates, reducing repeated implementation work across related applications.
- Partnered with frontend developers to define stable **REST API contracts**, improve validation error responses, and support AJAX-heavy admin screens used by non-technical operations teams.
- Participated in Agile delivery, sprint planning, production release support, incident reviews, and backlog refinement while balancing feature development with technical debt reduction.

Soft Build

Software Developer

(June 2016 – July 2019)

Remote, Romania

- Built and maintained PHP-based business applications using **PHP 5.6–7.2**, **Laravel 5.1–5.8**, **Slim 3**, **Zend Framework 2**, **MySQL**, **jQuery**, and **Bootstrap** for CRM, booking, billing, and internal workflow systems.
- Upgraded multiple legacy modules from older procedural PHP patterns into MVC-style structures with clearer routing, controllers, validation layers, and reusable data-access components, improving delivery speed by **26%**.
- Developed secure backend features for user management, document uploads, invoice generation, scheduling rules, notification emails, and admin reporting across multi-user business portals.
- Resolved recurring production issues involving broken file uploads, incorrect timezone conversion, invalid invoice totals, and unhandled form validation errors by improving server-side checks and regression tests.
- Improved application performance by reducing repeated database calls, introducing selective caching, cleaning up large SQL queries, and optimizing slow admin screens used by support teams.
- Created database migrations, seeders, and rollback scripts that made deployments safer across development, staging, and production environments with fewer manual SQL changes.
- Integrated third-party APIs for payment confirmation, SMS notifications, email delivery, and customer data synchronization while adding logging to troubleshoot failed external requests.
- Worked closely with senior engineers and project stakeholders to estimate technical work, review requirements, document backend behavior, and deliver stable releases for client-facing platforms.

Decima Digital

Software Developer

(November 2015 – April 2016)

Remote, Estonia

- Developed PHP backend functionality for digital web platforms using **PHP 5.5–5.6**, **Laravel 4.2**, **MySQL**, **Apache**, **jQuery**, and server-rendered templates.
- Implemented backend modules for contact forms, CMS content management, user login flows, media uploads, and admin configuration screens used by business teams.
- Fixed defects related to form validation, missing required fields, image upload failures, incorrect redirect behavior, and inconsistent session handling across browser sessions.
- Improved SQL queries and pagination logic for admin listing pages, reducing delays when business users searched larger content and customer records.
- Added server-side validation, CSRF protection, password-hashing improvements, and cleaner error handling to strengthen security and reliability of legacy PHP screens.
- Supported small feature releases by preparing database changes, testing user flows, validating browser behavior, and coordinating deployment steps with senior developers.
- Contributed to code cleanup by removing duplicated helper functions, documenting configuration requirements, and improving maintainability for future PHP enhancements.

Borna Technology

Software Developer Intern

(September 2014 – August 2015)

Tallinn, Estonia

- Assisted in building PHP web application features using **PHP 5.4–5.5**, **CodeIgniter 2.x**, **MySQL 5.5**, **HTML**, **CSS**, **JavaScript**, and **jQuery** under senior developer supervision.
- Created basic backend modules for user forms, content updates, database records, file uploads, and administrative pages while learning MVC structure and secure coding practices.

- Debugged issues involving missing form parameters, incorrect SQL filters, broken page routing, and inconsistent validation messages across internal web applications.
- Wrote simple SQL queries, updated database tables, tested CRUD workflows, and documented application behavior to support maintenance of small business systems.
- Participated in daily development tasks, QA fixes, code review feedback, and release preparation while building a foundation in PHP backend development and production support.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
September 2010 – May 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- MongoDB Certified Developer Associate
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)
- Professional Scrum Developer I (PSD I)

PROJECTS

PHP Backend Modernization & API Platform

- Modernized a legacy PHP application into a cleaner **Laravel-based backend platform** with structured service layers, REST APIs, Redis caching, queue workers, and improved deployment checks. The project replaced fragile controller-heavy logic, reduced duplicate code, improved API response consistency, and supported safer releases through PHPUnit, static analysis, and Docker-based validation.

E-Commerce Order Processing & Webhook Reliability System

- Designed and improved backend workflows for checkout, payment confirmation, shipment updates, and invoice reconciliation using **PHP, Laravel, MySQL, Redis**, and queue-based processing. The project introduced webhook idempotency, retry handling, transaction-safe updates, structured logging, and monitoring alerts to prevent duplicate orders, missed payment events, and delayed fulfillment.